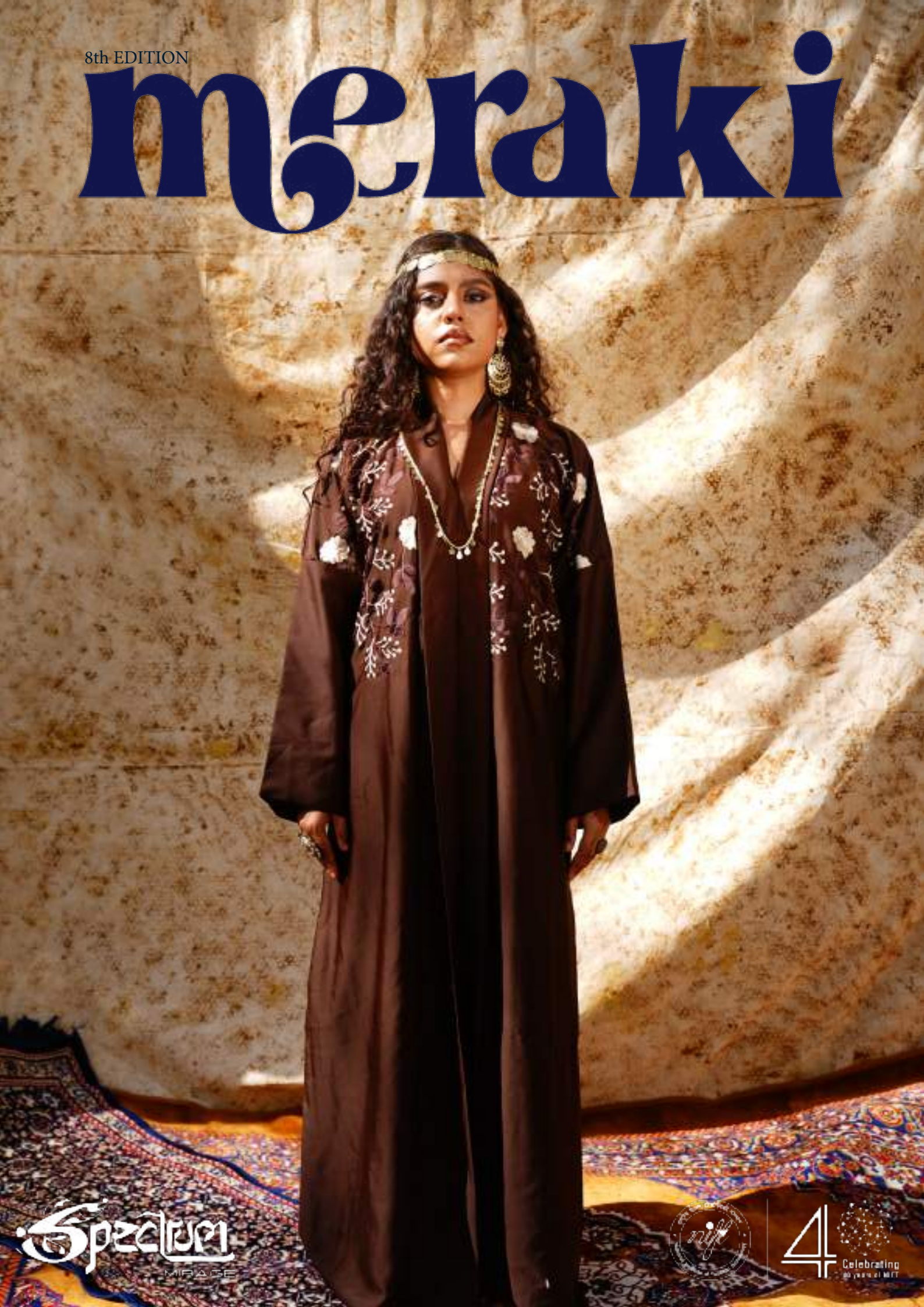
8th EDITION

meraki



Spectrum
MIRAGE

nift

40 Celebrating

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DIRECTOR'S NOTE

It is with great pride and excitement that I present MERAKI's eighth edition, a celebration of creativity, vision, and the boundless power of imagination. This year's theme, Mirage, is more than an exploration of illusions—it is a testament to the creative mind's ability to see beyond the tangible, to craft meaning from the ephemeral, and to reimagine the world as we know it.

Creativity thrives on the interplay of perception and imagination. A mirage is not merely an illusion; it is a possibility—a vision that urges us to build, to transform, and to innovate. In the creative workspace, mirages are essential. They push us to imagine beyond, to reframe the existing, and to weave ideas into realities. Every great design, every profound story, every artistic endeavor begins as an illusion—an idea waiting to be realized.

This edition of MERAKI is a tribute to those who dare to imagine, to those who find meaning in the unseen, and to those who shape visions into existence. Each page reflects the relentless spirit of our students, their artistry, and their pursuit of creation beyond boundaries.

I extend my deepest gratitude to everyone who has contributed to this edition, for it is your vision and dedication that bring MERAKI to life. May this magazine inspire you to embrace the mirage, to chase the intangible, and to reimagine the world with every stroke, word, and idea.

Warm regards,
Prof. Dr. Malini Divakala





THEME NOTE

In Persian craftsmanship, a single flaw is woven into every rug—an intentional mistake, a quiet defiance against perfection. This belief, known as the Persian Flaw, stems from the idea that only the divine can create without error. Imperfection, then, is not failure but a mark of humanity. Mirage of Perfection draws from this philosophy, exploring the illusions we chase and the beauty found in the flawed. Like a rug's intricate knots, life's imperfections create depth, texture, and meaning—revealing that perfection was never the point.

Life, too, is a tapestry woven with illusions—expectations that falter, miscommunications that distort, perceptions that shift like sand in the wind. We chase ideals, believing them to be tangible, only to find they dissolve upon arrival. The mirage of perfection exists in the way we define success, in the images we curate, in the roles we play. Yet, just as the Persian weaver embraces the flaw, perhaps we, too, must learn to find meaning not in what is seamless, but in what is real.

With Meraki's 9th edition, Mirage, step into a world where reality bends and perception reigns. Sail through the shifting dunes of ambition, navigate the mirages of expectation, and embrace the flawed, the unfinished, the beautifully imperfect. For in the end, it is not perfection but the journey through illusion that gives life its depth.





Flawed Horizons

Concept: Uday
Art Direction: Uday and Shaivi
Hair and Makeup: Noor
Photography: Varshita and Gouri
General Assistance: Harshita Mehta, Ishita Banerjee, Himanshu
Model: Samiya
Special thanks to Film & Photography club and Creatives team





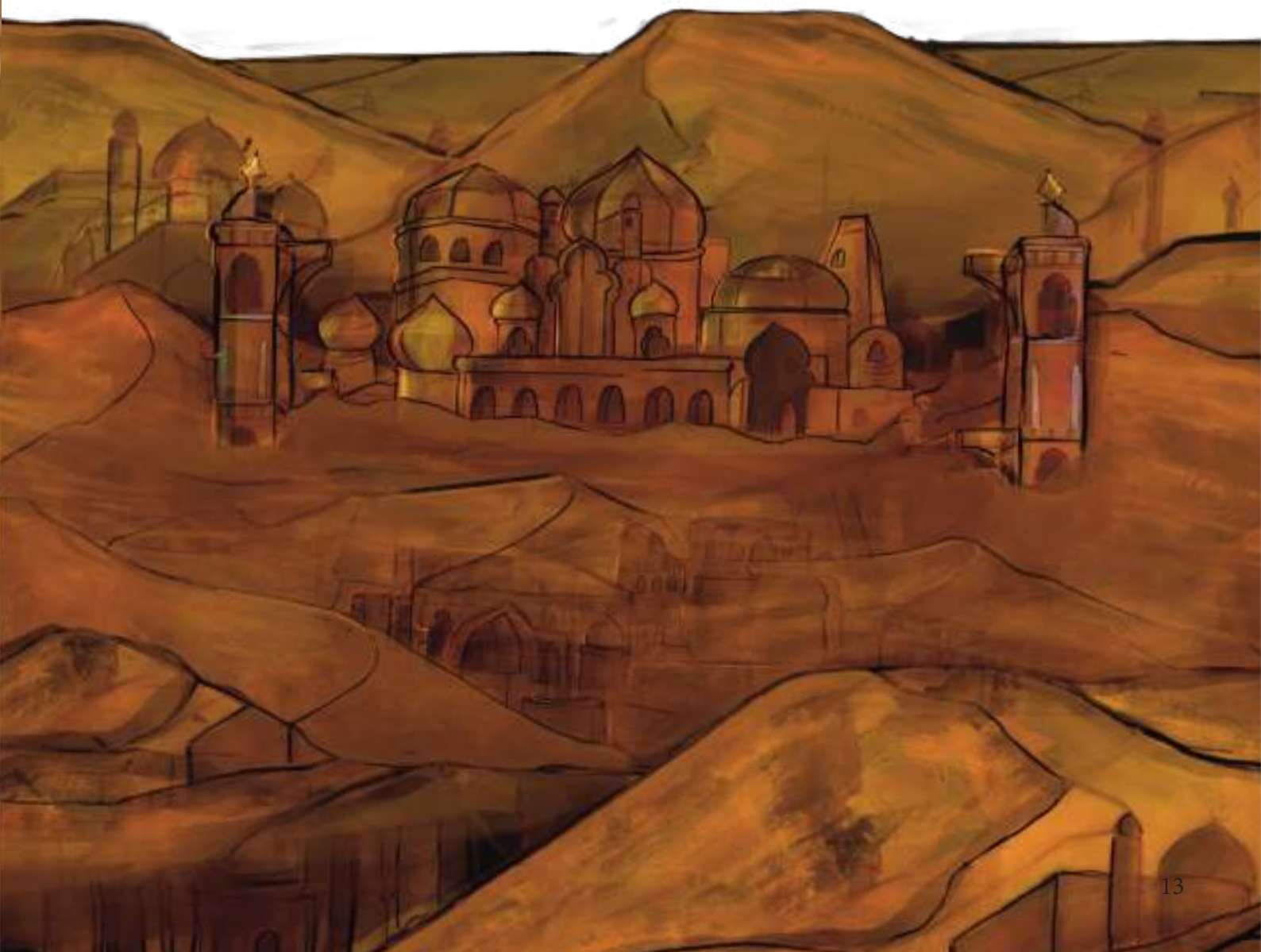
SWALLOWED BY SAND

Written by Tanya

Designed by Rakshana

Swallowed by the vastness of sand, buried under that thick layer, are a number of known and unknown facts and myths. As cities submerged, there emerged numerous folklore and tales bringing them closer to us from miles and centuries away.

How else would you know the lost city of Ubar if not for its legend that runs almost parallel to the fabled island of Atlantis, earning it the name "Atlantis of the Sands." Residing under the depths of Rub-al-Khali (Desert Empty Quarter) in the Arabian Peninsula, it was once a prospering trading post. As the city flourished, its people turned sinful, and pride took the best of them.



They built tall, awe-striking structures flaunting their power. The Quran mentions this as the "Iram of the Pillars", hinting at their growing feeling of superiority. Soon, they acquired enough arrogance to anger the Gods and were faced with violent winds for seven days, burying the city under layers of sand. This is how the legend ends, but the discovered ruins of the city suggest that its dwellings were built on a limestone cavern system, and as the underground waters dried up, the caverns collapsed, leading to the decline of the city. Now, the truth is uncertain, but if only the city was planned better or the masses weren't deluded by arrogance, we could see for ourselves the conviction of the Iram of the Pillars.

Another such city lying deep under the sands of our own land is "Talakadu". On a regular day in ancient Karnataka, Tala and Kada, two hunters, were astonished to see a tree being worshipped by elephants. Giving in to that curiosity, they decided to cut open that tree. To their surprise, the tree bled. Legend says it was Lord Shiva himself and the elephants, sages. After realisation and a desperate attempt at fixing the wounds of the tree, they got to witness the Lord himself, who guided them to moksha. The city was then named after these two hunters and the temple that stands at the place of that tree is now called the Vaideyshwara temple.

In later years, this very temple was visited by the sick king of Vijayanagar in hopes of better health. His health never improved and only worsened thereafter. When hopes of recovery seemed bleak, his wife, Alamelamma, came rushing to him, entrusting their kingdom to the king of Mysore. There are now a few different versions of the legend. Some say this king wanted the jewels possessed by the queen, while some say he had eyes on the queen herself. Whatever the ambition, the king attacked Talakadu, taking advantage of the queen's vulnerable state.



Alamelamma, finding no way to flee, drowned herself along with her jewels in the waters of the river Cauvery (Kaveri) in Malangi. This was not before she uttered the curse, "Talakadu maralagali, Malangi maduvagali, Mysuru dhorege makkalilladhe hogali", which translates to "May Talakadu be filled with Sand; Malangi be a whirlpool and let the Mysuru Raja never have an heir". Some parts of this curse still hold good as the city is submerged in sand, and the heirs to the Mysuru royal family were all adopted up until recently.

Once completely crushed under the weight of this curse, Talakadu is now an interesting display of temples. Some of these can not be visited during the monsoon due to being filled with water and sand, while some are below ground level. There are still about 30 temples waiting to be unearthed in Talakadu.

A century ago, a set so grand was built that deplacing it was a tedious chore. Filmmaker Cecil B. Demille in 1923 went on to create the biggest set in history at that time for his movie "The Ten Commandments". The set was so huge that carrying it back to Hollywood was expensive, but leaving it there in the presence of rival filmmakers was a major risk too. Some of the artefacts from the set were already taken to serve as decoratives at different places and what remained was ordered by the filmmaker to be dismantled and secretly buried underground. The city lay there, forgotten for decades until the remains were located by a bunch of film buffs. Now a variety of these artefacts are exhibited at the Dunes Centre in Gaudalupe, CA in a fascinating exhibit.

All of these once magnificent displays now wait to be rescued by someone. It's almost like a reminder of the ultimate decay. When existence rises from absence, it's all to vanish again because tangible can't hold itself for eternity. All that remains are whispers from the underground that wander from ear to ear through the sea and the lands and beyond the constraints of time.



AN ODE TO ROHIT BAL

India's master of fabric and fashion, Rohit Bal, fondly known as Gudda was the golden thread of our industry-binding heritage, artistry, and drama into masterpieces that transcend time. His journey began when he pursued his passion for design at the National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), New Delhi where he honed the skills that would later define his iconic career. Since the start of his label in 1990, he has held court as one of India's most celebrated designers, a maestro who transforms fabric into poetry. His designs are not just creations but an experience, a fusion of colour, texture, and emotion that leaves a mark on all those who encounter them.

Born in the valleys of Kashmir, Bal's vision was deeply rooted in the beauty of his homeland. The lotus blossoms, the peacock feathers, and the intricate motifs of Indian craftsmanship, these elements spoke of his identity.

The Gulbagh collection, an ode to Mughal gardens reflected his reverence for Indian heritage with its floral symphony of Zardosi and chintz prints. His intricate embroidery techniques breathe life into centuries-old traditions, while his dramatic silhouettes challenged the boundaries of conventional couture. But it's not just the clothes—it's the theatre of it all. Rohit Bal's runway shows were like a dream materialised, each one more spectacular than the last.

His desire for grandeur was unmatched, with elaborate sets, hauntingly beautiful music, and an air of mystique that draws you into his world.

Each collection is like a love letter to India, told through threads of gold and the swish of silk. Whether it's models adorned with lotus crowns or his iconic white floor-length anarkalis, Bal's shows were a visual feast and a celebration of his creative genius.

His artistry had captured the world too, from Naomi Campbell to Deepika Padukone, he had dressed global icons with an elegance that is distinctly Indian. His collaborations with brands like Christian Louboutin and esteemed labels further cemented his position as an ambassador of Indian design on the global stage.
As we celebrate Rohit Bal, we honour not just a designer but a visionary who has elevated Indian couture. His final show at Lakme Fashion Week, Kaaynat, was a celebration of beauty, and circularity of nature, a masterpiece, a poetic farewell that embodied the drama, elegance, and heritage he championed throughout his career. In his world, fashion is more than what you wear, it's how you dream, how you remember, and how you express your soul. A body of work that immortalizes the heart of India and a spirit that will continue to inspire generations to come. And for that, we remain forever in awe of Rohit Bal.

Written by Kashvi
Designed by Riya



Courtesy of Rohit Bal's KAAYNAAT lookboook 2024

ON A DIFFERENT NOTE

She's seated slightly off the diagonal from me- 3 seats to my right and 2 rows ahead. So close yet so far. I pause. My hands are reaching inside my bag before I know it. 4 fingers grip the piece of parchment inside. 2 pens. Black stands out more on parchment. I pick up the blue one.

1 paper. Too many words.

"The issue with apologies is that they often serve to 'wipe away' the wrongdoing by shifting the burden onto the hurt person. The burden of expending emotional energy to fix the situation. Which is why this is not an apology but more of an account on my end. I know you're hurt. Pretty vicious, my ironic loop of hurting people in an attempt to not hurt them. I've been so caught up in trying to embody that persona. The persona which feels completely foreign to me. Disconnected from who I truly am. Miles away from my core."

12 minutes. Till the metal gong starts bawling.

"I often wonder how someone like me, who's so full of their own struggles can be a good friend. Someone who's not even transparent to themselves. Someone who can't even face their own self.

Still, despite all that, I wish that perhaps you'll linger by my side as I shape myself anew. Maybe you'll stay beside me while I give the girl behind the tangle of veils a chance. To break through, leaving behind mere torn pieces of fabric. The fabric that once wrapped me in a sense of security from the world around me. An armour built with lies. The fabric which now feels like shards of glass piercing my skin. Skin that craves for you"

2 blue thumbs gripping the paper.
4 bold creases and folds.
A couple of footsteps.



I heard the gruff voice of the teacher say *"The Battle of Trenton was fought between the American troops, led by George Washington, and the Hessians, who were German mercenaries. The Americans were victorious, but the outcome could have easily been very different."*

I looked at her, not directly though, I couldn't meet her gaze. Her reflection caught my eye, I saw her on the surface of the metal gong of the class bell, scribbling away.

Now, I dislike her, and I'm sure it's the same for her. But what if she never liked me in the first place? What if I just made it all up? Was it all just a lie that my mind came up with? Was the truth always laid out in front of me, but I just chose to ignore it?

I really should just pay attention in class. But before I could regain my focus, she passed by me, leaving a folded piece of parchment on my desk. Before I could understand what just happened, my hands put the note in my pocket, and I did not listen to a single word after that.

The teacher continued *"A note was found in the coat of Johann Rall, the Hessian commander. It was from a spy and it contained the whereabouts of the American troops. The unread note, which could have turned the war in favour of the Hessians, was still in his pocket when he died in battle."*



Written by Vibha & Simar
Designed by Kalyani

RATTLES AND THOUGHTS

Written by Vibha
Designed by Shubhangi Kakati

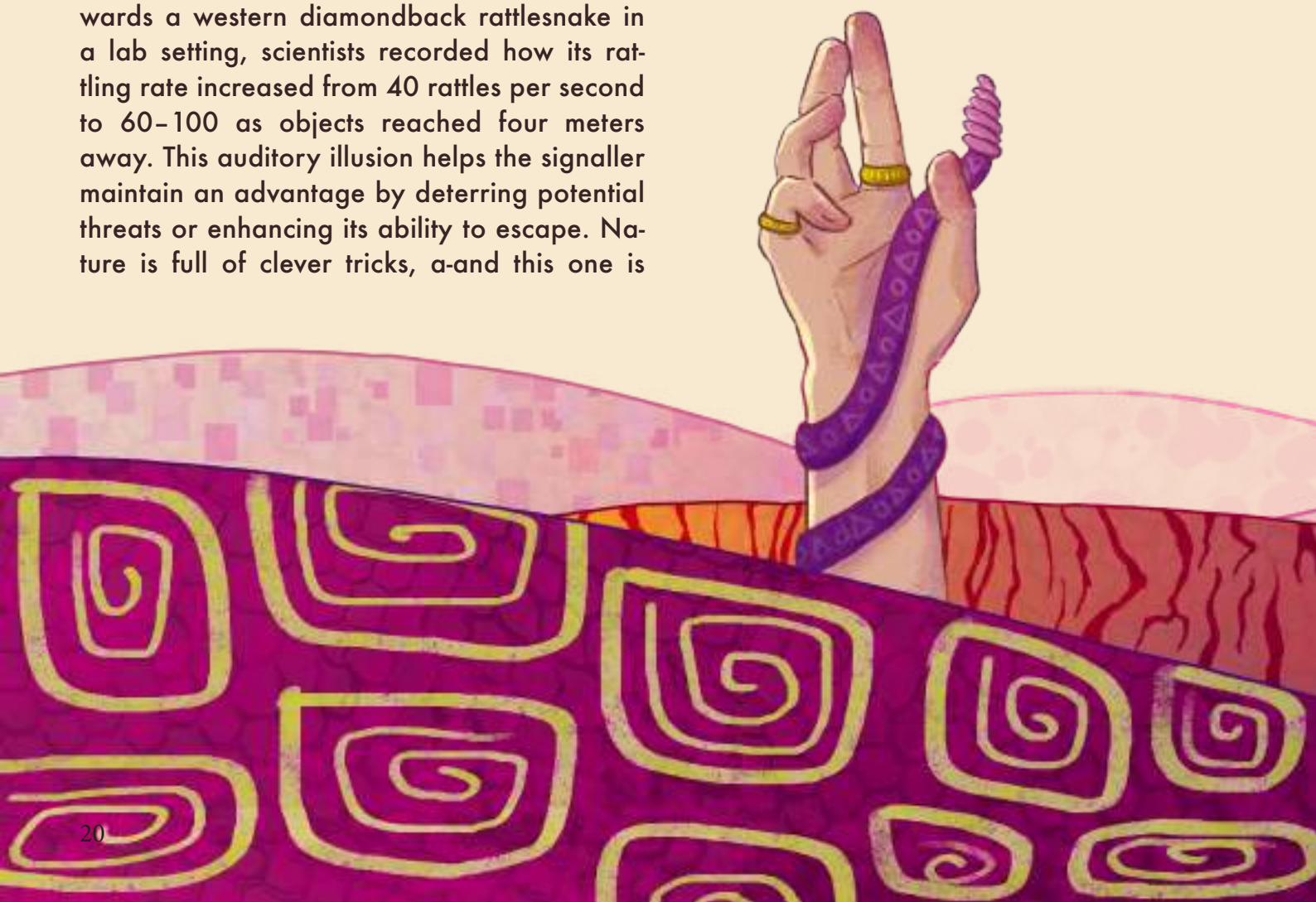
"Some animals, such as the Galápagos tortoise, live their entire lives in one place. Others, such as the monarch butterfly and Arctic tern, migrate. Animals have adapted to..." National Geographic is the only thing that plays on our ancient TV. Since my dad quit work and embraced his old age, he watches it religiously. At this point, I'm pretty sure I can name at least 17 different species of rats in a single breath. "...impacts include creating migration-kzzztbz-installing wildlife-friendly... zzzbtzzz" the sporty looking dude in camouflage was interrupted by our old TV's static.

"By pushing a human-like dummy slowly towards a western diamondback rattlesnake in a lab setting, scientists recorded how its rattling rate increased from 40 rattles per second to 60–100 as objects reached four meters away. This auditory illusion helps the signaller maintain an advantage by deterring potential threats or enhancing its ability to escape. Nature is full of clever tricks, a-and this one is all abou–kkshhh–about so–bzzzt–..." Stupid old TV. I grab the remote control and furiously press the power button. Defeated, I let it be.

I think about what I just learnt about rattlesnakes. It did catch my attention, I won't lie. You learn something new every day, I suppose. The sporty dude continues, "The sudden switch to the high-frequency mode acts as a smart signal, fooling the listener about its actual distance to the sound source."

Interesting how something far away can seem to be so nearby. My mind starts racing. I glance at my dad watching the show intently. I'm sitting at the edge of the couch because that's the only way I can sit next to him. His thighs rest lifelessly on the metal wheelchair. It has been almost 4 years since his world got restricted to that one single chair.

For years, I've struggled with an intense fear of growing older. The thought of me as a wrinkly, grey-haired, bedridden old woman instils me with crippling anxiety. My trail of thoughts



drowns the TV static. New ones arising faster than they can be processed. Studies say that racing thoughts indicate repetitive thought patterns, like a hamster circling around in a hamster wheel. There are countless things I have yet to do, to experience. So many things that even another lifetime might not be enough. The thought of physically and mentally being unable to experience all those things and everything else I enjoy haunts me to my core. Having my body deteriorate to the point where I'm unable to use my hands as well as my legs, being stuck in a body that's 94% non-functional seems terrifying.

The wheelchair looks pretty rusty now as compared to when I first saw him in it. I was small back then, but I clearly remember his utterly helpless and painful transition to this new life. The thought that someday I will constantly need someone to take care of me, the same way I did for him is genuinely petrifying.

Tik-tok.

My thoughts are interrupted by the old-fashioned wooden clock on the side-table ironically informing me that time is indeed ticking away. Sporty-looking dude is now demonstrating how the rattlesnake tricked him into thinking that it's nearby, whereas in reality it just started rattling really loudly.

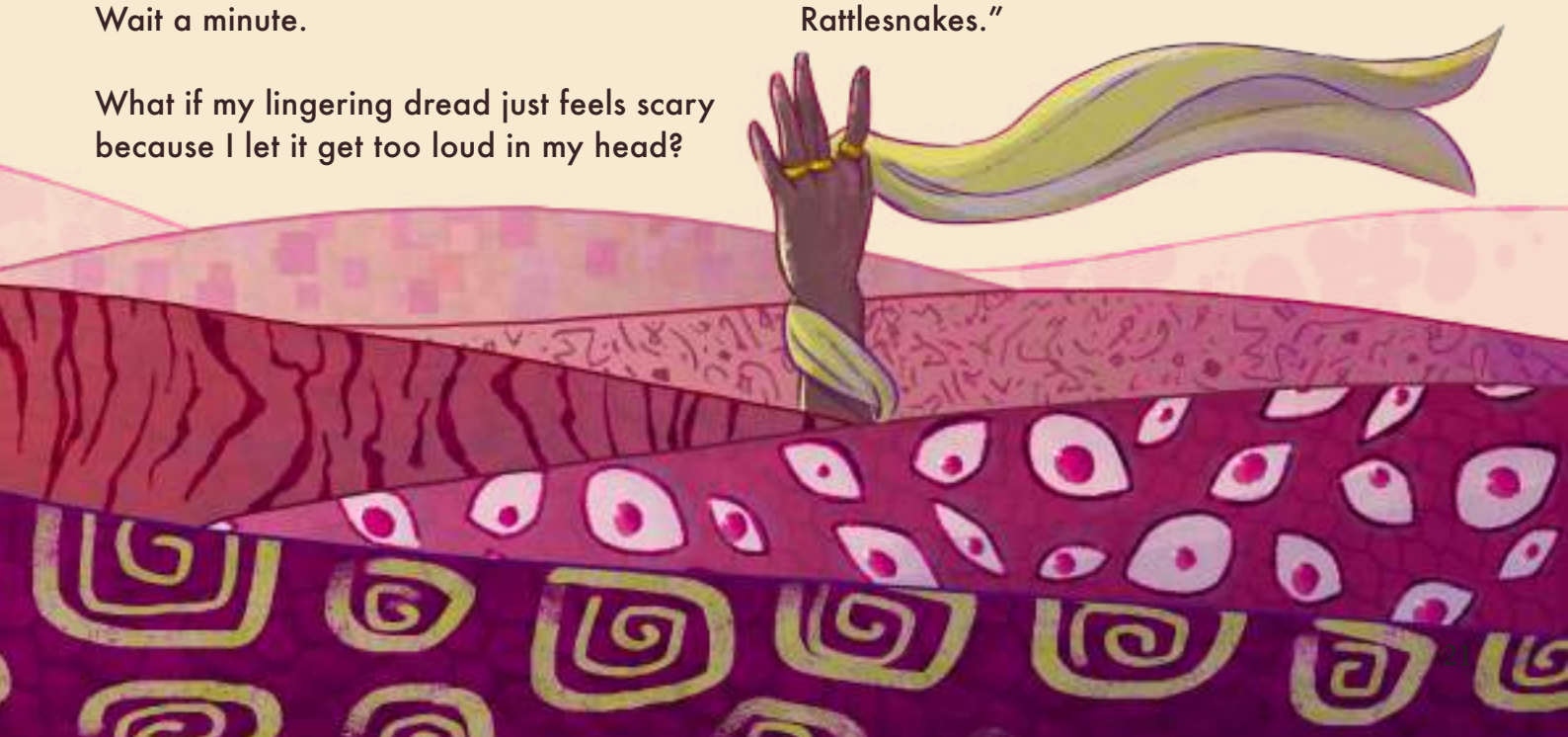
Wait a minute.

What if my lingering dread just feels scary because I let it get too loud in my head?

What if it's actually far away, but it only feels terrifyingly close because every time I try to confront it, my thoughts become overwhelmingly loud? What if my fear was just a rattlesnake all along? And whenever I get into its proximity, it rattles so loud, so loud that it feels like it's arrived here already and sends me into that horrific loop of anxiety and panic. Like a never-ending tunnel that keeps getting deeper and darker. Whenever I'm scared of anything I feel hopeless and defeated, but maybe that's just me letting its intensity and loudness overpower me.
I think of all the times I've let any of my fears, the rattlesnakes get the best of me. There's a whole colony of little rattlesnakes inside my head and I never knew. Each one with a distinctive sound. I wonder what rattlesnakes reside inside other people's heads. Someone must be sharing one of mine, right? And if we do share one, then do they rattle with the same intensity or is theirs louder or gentler than mine?

I think of my dad, who seemingly can't get enough of sporty dude's commentary. What about his rattlesnakes? If he has any, he must have encountered and dealt with dozens by now at his age. In fact, he's the very embodiment of my loudest one.

I try to steal a glance at him, but he catches me, a certain glimmer in his eye. His familiar voice echoes in my ear, "Clever beings, huh? Rattlesnakes."



Killed it or not?

Written by



Siman Renu



Malavika Pramod

Illustrated by



Vishakha AN

#1 GHOSTFACE



hair tuck

I mean- umm - SORRY?!?!

YESS, but he couldn't have dressed up in a more basic fit to kill

He definitely wasn't killing it, the mask is the only good thing

But it looks as if you've just offended a dementor

OMG HP crossover ho gaya



11/10



#2 BILLY LOOMIS



8/10

Salman Khan in Tere Naam

Salman Khan 144P



Someone give him shampoo

Shower once in a while

But like he does give off those dark romance vibes

#3 LEATHER FACE



Leather face. You didn't stick out to me.



His day = get ready for job interview ← get rejected ← kill people

It you wanna hide your ugly face, atleast wear a pretty mask

This mask is your best work? REDO!

4/10

brownie points for the chainsaw

#4 FREDDY KRUGER



First of all ew. Second of all EWWWW

Top hat cause bald broooh he reallyyy needs a hair trasplant

Nahh, he needs a plastic surgeon atp

-100/10

#5 PREDATOR

Bro skips his legs days

And then chooses to wear a metal diaper over it



His face broo- WHY DOES HE HAVE THAT MANY TEETH

And still no hair on his head



0/10

#6 DR HANNIBAL



6/10

He took it too seriously

Dr Hannibal? More like Dr Cannibal

Hey cmon we all love a man who can cook

Did he get eliminated from Master chef India or something?

I mean - eliminated or not, cooked with the fit ✓

#7 MICHAEL MYERS



6/10

Dude, his mask is on point

IKRRR, its the only good thing about him tho

The hair + janitor clothes + school shoes = BADDD

He is giving - NOTHING!

#8 NOSFERATU





#9 PEARL



Wannabe sigma boy but she's a woman,
WE LOVE HER <3

HER DRESS IS CUTE COME ON

But I think her dress is the reason she couldn't becomee a STARRR

I think it had more to do with the axe and blood

7.5/10

#10 RATCHED NURSE

This is how put together I think I look during Jury

ISTG all her outfits were ON POINT

Whats up with the hair thoo???

2000s puffed hair gone wrong?



8/10

#11 JENNIFER'S BODY



I support womens rights, but most importantly I support womens wrongs

MOTHER IS MOTHERING- I AM ON MY KNEES

AND SHE GOES BOTH WAYSSS

GODDESS LEVEL /10

DESERT FASHION:
A Timeless Blend of Tradition and Modernity

Written by Shruti

Designed by Arushi

The desert, characterised by its golden dunes, shifting landscapes, and contrasts, has served as a consistent source of inspiration for the world of fashion. Desert clothing, once a symbol of survival and practicality, has now affected mainstream fashion, blending traditional elements with unconventional designs. From the flowing abayas of the Middle East to the avant-garde creations of modern-day designers, desert-inspired fashion is a testament to the enduring beauty of the arid landscapes.



Desert fashion emphasises lightweight fabrics like cotton, linen, ramie and sheer or mesh fabrics. Traditional garments like the abaya and the tagelmust were designed for the protection of wearers from the harsh desert environment while simultaneously maintaining a sense of their cultural identity. The abaya, a versatile flowing robe worn in the Middle East, is often adorned with intricate embroidery, making it practical and beautiful. The tagelmust, an indigo-dyed veil worn by the people of the Sahara, serves as protection from the sun and sandstorms. Djellabas are long, loose-fitting robes with hoods made from breathable fabrics like cotton or wool. The hood, known as a qob, serves both a functional and styling purpose.



In recent years, the desert aesthetic has gained popularity, not just in regions with arid climates but across the globe. The rise of festive fashion has played a significant role in bringing desert-inspired styles into the mainstream markets. Brands like Zimmermann incorporate lightweight fabrics, and relaxed silhouettes suited for the desert and beach lifestyle. Mirror work and traditional embroideries from Rajasthan's Thar Desert are one of the sources of inspiration for popular Indian designers like Anita Dongre's bridal wear collections. At the 2023 Met Gala, Zendaya wore a flowing, earth-toned gown with intricate beadwork and a draped veil, while Bella Hadid stunned at Cannes in a sheer, sand-coloured dress with metallic accents. At Paris Fashion Week 2023, Naomi Campbell walked the runway in a desert-inspired ensemble which was an asymmetrical, sand-hued gown with layers of chiffon, and a headpiece reminding us of the desert dunes.

Several designers have drawn inspiration from desert landscapes for their collections, incorporating earthy tones and flowing silhouettes into their ensembles. In early 2023, Thebe Magugu presented his "Discard Theory" collection at the Victoria and Albert Museum, showcasing designs that reflect the rich culture of the Sahara. In August 2023, Rajesh Pratap Singh unveiled his 'Desert Rose' collection at India Couture Week, featuring woven, embroidered, and printed ensembles that reflected the grandeur of Indian weddings and the vastness of deserts. In January 2024, Elie Saab unveiled his Spring/Summer 2024 Haute Couture collection, "A Desert Rose," which drew inspiration from the medina and desert landscapes, featuring luxurious textures and colours from the arid terrains. Recently, in March 2025, Giorgio Armani showcased his Autumn/Winter 2025 collection named 'Roots' at Milan Fashion Week, emphasising earthy tones and natural textures, with garments in golden, sandy, beige, and grey shades, reflecting a desert-inspired colour palette.





Colour palette inspiration drawn from the deserts is becoming a dominant trend in fashion, offering a sense of warmth and sophistication. These palettes usually include shades like sandy beige, warm taupe, golden ochre, terracotta, deep cocoa, and muted clay. The blend of these colours creates a natural, effortless charm that aligns with today's focus on sustainability and minimalism.



PPG's 2025 Colour of the Year,

"Mocha Mousse",

is a rich, grounding brown that reflects the warmth of sunbaked earth. Pantone's 2024 "Peach Fuzz" blends well with warm neutrals to capture the gentle radiance of desert sunsets. Behr's 2024 "Cracked Pepper," a deep neutral, contrasts beautifully with lighter desert hues, adding depth and modernity. These hues complement one another to create a palette that is timeless and adaptable.

Desert fashion isn't just a fleeting trend—it's a movement that embodies sustainability and effortless elegance. Rooted in centuries-old traditions yet constantly evolving, it merges practicality with high fashion. As climate-conscious design gains traction, desert-inspired aesthetics align perfectly with the shift towards sustainable, nature-driven fashion. Desert Fashion's influence is rapidly growing, inspired by its raw beauty and adaptability.



Vanishing Visions

This shoot embodies the essence of a mirage—an illusion that feels almost tangible yet remains just out of reach. The model appears as a fleeting vision, blending into the decayed space, suspended between reality and illusion. Inspired by the shifting, wavering nature of heat distortions, the interplay of fabric, light, and shadow creates a dreamlike presence, making it unclear whether she belongs to this place or is merely a figment of the imagination. High contrasts between light and shadow heighten the illusion, creating a shimmer reminiscent of distant, unreachable oases.

The juxtaposition of the ethereal model against the raw, abandoned setting enhances the feeling of displacement as if she exists in a liminal space between past and present, material and immaterial. Muted, washed-out tones reinforce the dreamlike quality, evoking a sense of longing and mystery. The mirage, by nature, is a symbol of unattainable desire—something seen but never grasped, always shifting just beyond reach. “Vanishing Visions” is an interplay of illusion and uncertainty that challenges the viewer to question what is real, inviting them to lose themselves in the shimmering haze of the unseen.

Concept: Shaivi
Art Direction: Rishi and Shaivi
Styling: Rishi and Shaivi
Photography: Juswin Jacob
General Assistance: Lavanya and Kishan
Model: Pranavi Dantuluri















FREE FALLING INTO LIFE

Every night you decide that this is it, you're taking control. Tomorrow's a new day, and it's going to be perfect. You plan your day down to the minute because you're hard-wired to meticulously map out your future, with a to-do list so detailed it's almost a novel. You're going to be unstoppable. You do this every night, and it makes sense because we tend to crave order and predictability. Unpredictability means risk. So you plan over and over because maybe if you prepare just enough, life will cooperate.

The idea of absolute order can be comforting, but it's also almost suffocating. It is a deceptive illusion that makes you believe that every aspect of your life can be predicted. Embracing the imperfections that come with the whirlwind of unpredictability can be quite liberating. Giving in to the inevitable messiness in life and freefalling is exhilarating.

Lean into the madness. Growth often happens in the cracks, in the spaces between certainty. In the spaces where things seem broken, when things weren't "supposed" to happen. Maybe real meaning isn't in having control, but in embracing the unknown and letting life unfold naturally.

Written by Shrija
Designed by Gouri



This fit is on fire: FATAL FASHION TRENDS

Fashion trends come and go; some are here to stay and some to take your breath away (literally). Jumping onto new trends and staying up to date has always come naturally to us. With the need to fit in, we always leap in without second thoughts. Because of this, we have seen quite a lot of things going extremely wrong throughout history.

I mean, what's skincare without a bit of arsenic in it? Fitting in or standing out, both ended up being perilous back in the day. On the bright side, though, your favourite green dress will certainly outlive you.

From the working conditions to the components used in production, many have fallen victim to these fashion trends, wearer and maker alike.

Let's take a little walk through history and check out some 'walking' red flags that you would definitely not be adding to your shopping carts.

Crinolines

Starting off strong with this indispensable item from the 19th Century, enhancing silhouettes and committing crimes one ball at a time. These hoops, commonly made out of horse hair or steel and used as underskirts, caused over 3000 deaths in that era. Women wearing these were walking hazards, with the cage catching fire, knocking down candles and getting stuck on the wheels of carriages. At least they got a free ride, right?

There was a case where two women ended up blocking the doors during a fire because of their crinolines. These crinoline-induced deaths were getting out of hand but did not deter our fashion divas from wearing them until the thinner bustle skirts came into trend.

Green dyes

Scheele's green dyes were to die for, being all the rage in Victorian households. People loved the beautiful jewel-like colour, so much that it went from being in clothes to literally everything. You name it, they have it. Gowns, green. Carpets, green. Wallpapers, green. Vomit, green? These arsenic-infused green dyes were slowly poisoning the makers and wearers alike, causing rashes, ulcerations and vomiting. Little Miss Matilda Scheurer was adding a green bling to her fake flowers but unfortunately passed away from arsenic poisoning. It was reported that her nails, eyes and everything she looked at turned green. Maybe next time when you are wearing your favourite green dress, check if it smells like a mouse.

Venetian ceruse

This 16th-century skin whitener was a must-have in their makeup routines. Highly sought-after, expensive and all the way from Venice, this form of ceruse was a symbol of peak beauty. This mix of powdered lead and vinegar assisted in achieving a strangely pale skin complexion, symbolising fertility and youthfulness. I

mean the users looked youthful throughout their lifetime, as most of them succumbed to death early. Avid users of the Venetian ceruse experienced symptoms like skin scarring and pitting, infertility, hair loss and even death. Victims of vanity one can say, right?

Mercury treated hats

The Mad Hatter is kinda cool, but being mad as a hatter in the 18th century was definitely not. Hatters often used a mercuric compound to stiffen the felt for felt hats in the 1700s. This led to mercury poisoning among hatters, causing dementia and erethism. There was even a process called carroting; that's basically washing animal fur with an orange compound consisting of mercury. Hatmakers have played their fair share of roles in media, from Mad Hatter in Alice in Wonderland to Sophie in Howl's Moving Castle. The job is pretty romanticised, but in the 18th century? I'm afraid not.

Chopines

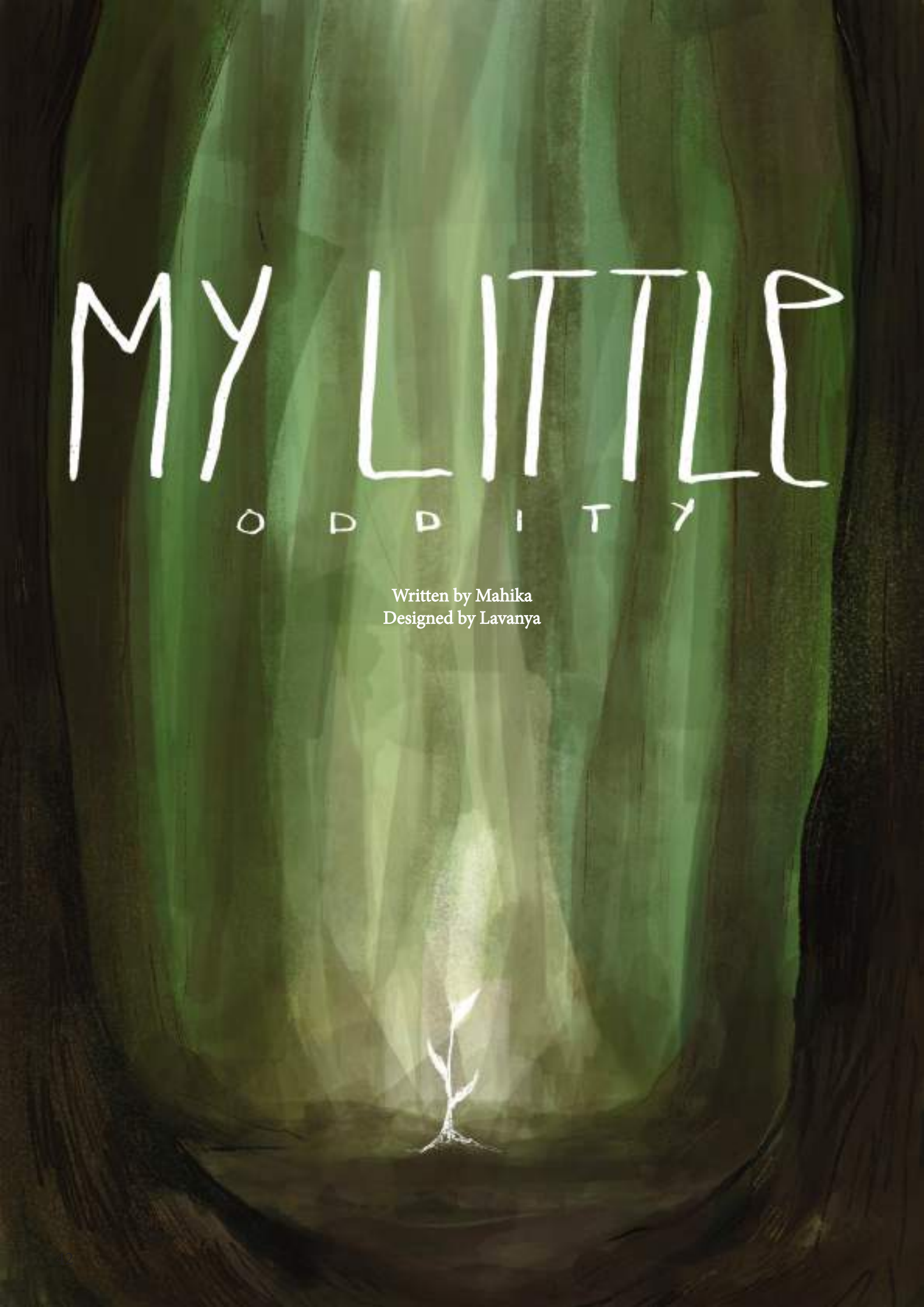
With the demand for 6'4 guys, short kings might be tempted to try these, but I assure you, no. These high-platform shoes were popular amongst Venetian women in the 15th to 17th centuries. Initially for protection from muddy roads and to keep their pretty little gowns squeaky clean, but also as a status symbol. Running behind status, these chopines soon turned into 'walking' red flags with 20-inch tall heels. They were mainly backless and most had an attendant to keep one stable.
Spoiler alert: that did NOT help.
Falling head over heels? No.
Falling off your heels? Definitely.
With a lot of accidents surfacing and people falling, laws were passed to keep it at a good 4 inches.

We all love a good pair of heels, but this?
We surely won't be adding these to our carts.

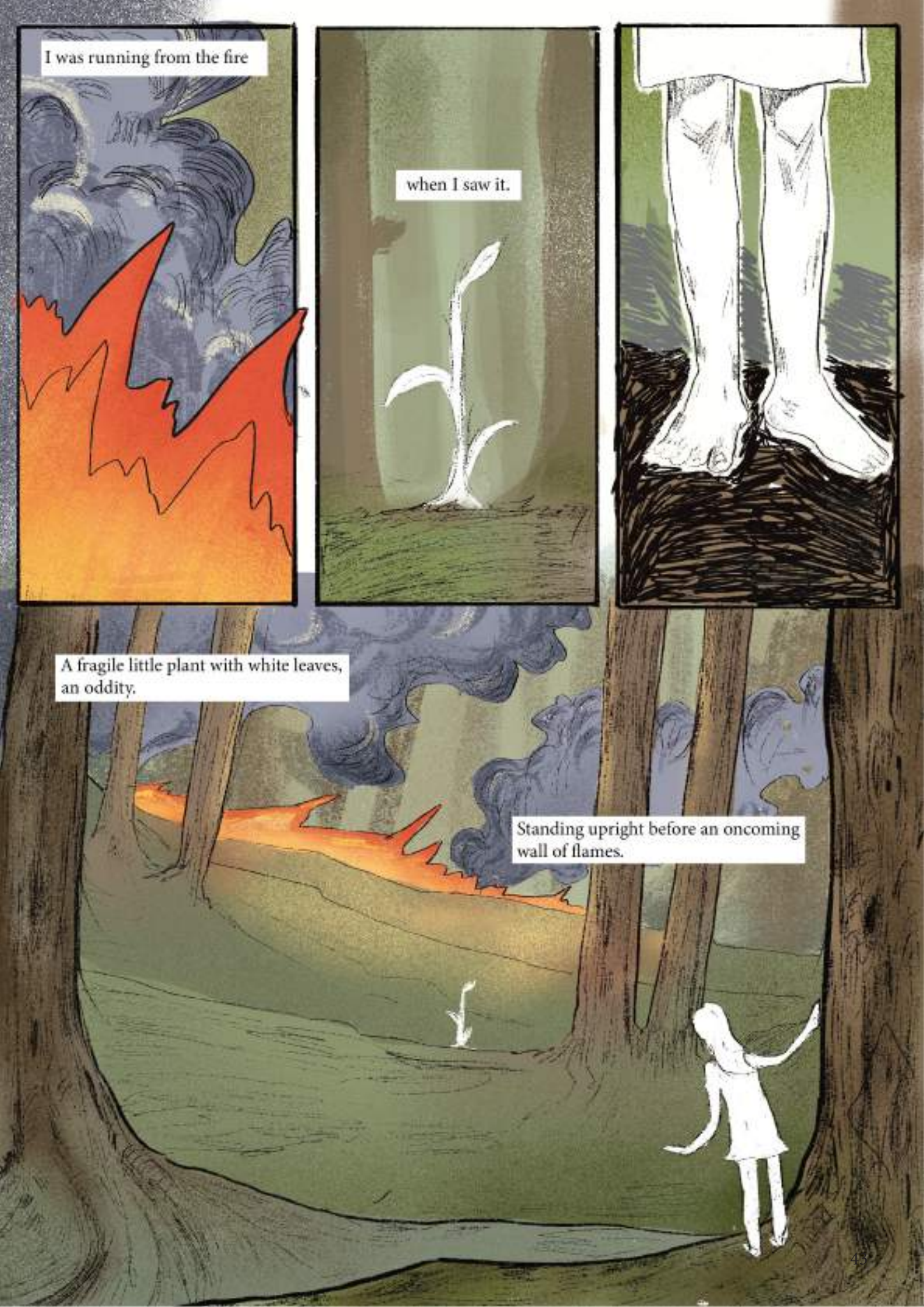
Sounds a tad bit scary, huh? What if I tell you we have put together a killer outfit (literally) for our dear gentle readers?



Written by Malavika
Designed by Nishat



Written by Mahika
Designed by Lavanya

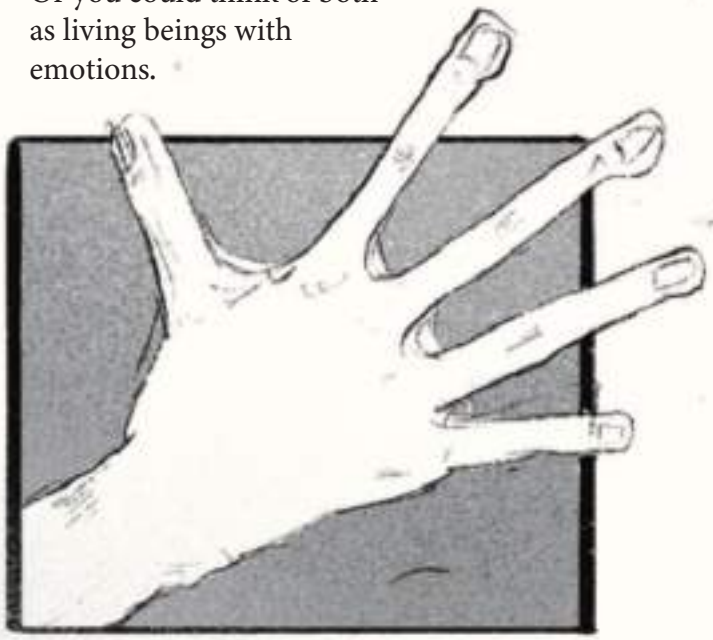

I was running from the fire
when I saw it.
A fragile little plant with white leaves, an oddity.
Standing upright before an oncoming wall of flames.

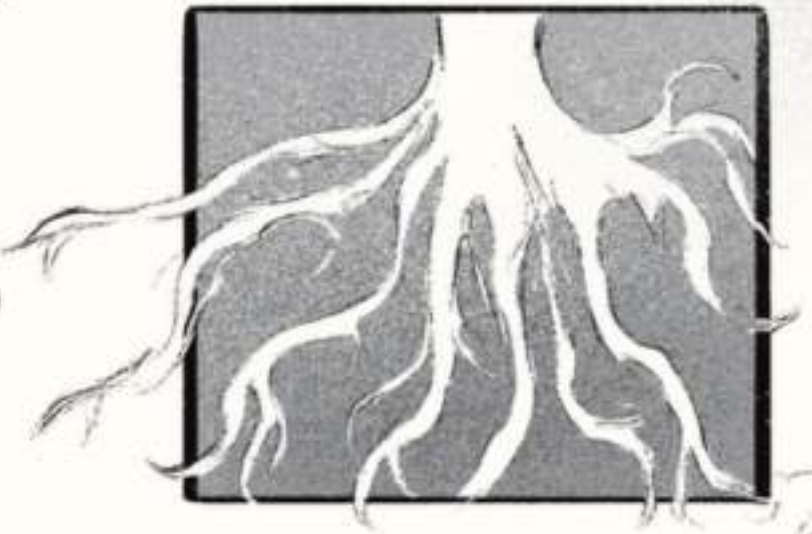

I don't know why I ran to it.
Maybe it was too fragile to be left at the mercy of the fire.
Maybe it reminded me of myself
who knows?
like calls to like after all.

You could think of humans as trees,

or trees as humans.

Or you could think of both as living beings with emotions.





Beings who need a companion to survive the torrent of life. And so, it was my little oddity and me.

In my backyard, safe within white walls.

To be continued...







THEME LAUNCH & PRO SHOW



The theme and mascot reveal was conducted by Director Prof. Dr. Malini Divakala, setting the stage for an unforgettable evening organized by Pro Show heads Rishi Chotlani, Prutha, and Rimzim Kapoor. Anchors Pranita Goyal and Vidushi Mishra kept the energy high as the Flash Mob kicked off the performances, thrilling the crowd with their dynamic moves.

The excitement only grew with a mesmerizing Fashion Show, led by Tammana Khan and team leaving the audience in awe. As the night continued, Artist Nignesh and Purani Jeans took over, keeping everyone on the edge of their seats with their melodies.

A special thanks to FPC for capturing every moment!

MEET THE



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Niharika, Japleen, Meghna



Finance
Raksha, Era, Khushi



ESSE
Vanshika, Dilna



Fashion
Dhanya, Atoche, Nithika

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Logistics
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